Venmo Redesign

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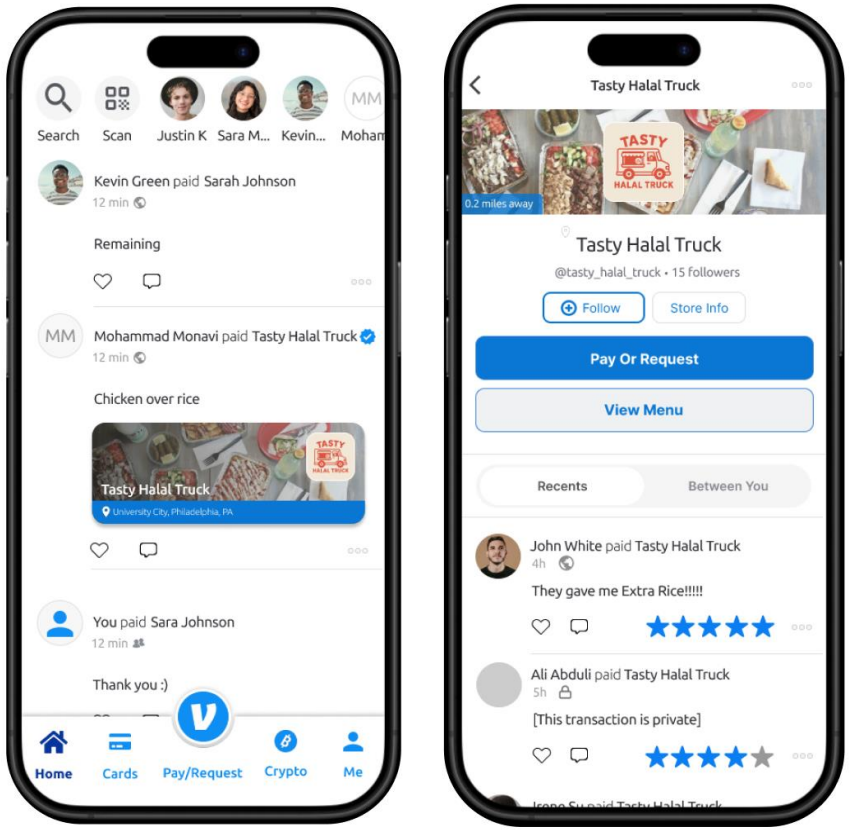
INFO 615 – DESIGNING WITH DATA, DR. SHRUTI PHADKE

05/29/2025



1- Project Background & Hypothesis

- **Project Overview:** Our project aims to redesign Venmo's business profiles, enhancing visibility, credibility, and user engagement for small businesses on the platform.

- **Why It Matters:** Currently, Venmo treats business accounts the same as personal profiles, offering no space for branding, product information, or customer reviews. This limits discoverability and trust.

- **Our Hypothesis:** We hypothesize that adding these elements will increase user trust, boost engagement, and support small business growth on the platform.

2- Phase 2 Setup and Design Considerations

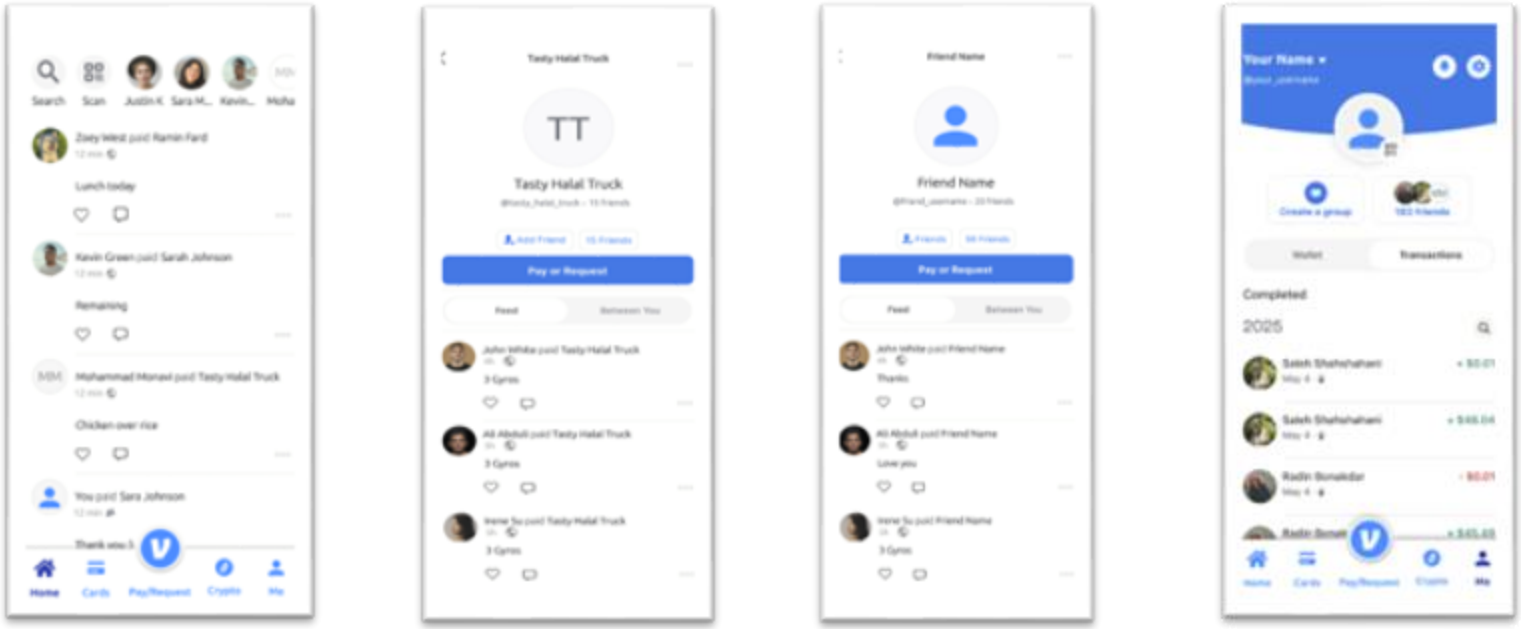
For the A/B test task Desing We wanted to craft a prompt that was both structured and exploratory:

"Imagine you just finished sending money to a friend on Venmo and you are back on the homepage of Venmo. Please spend some time and try to find a business/store profile. Feel free to click and interact around."

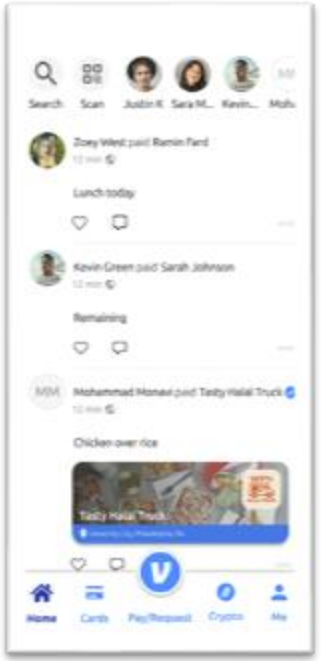
This setup gave us a more organic view of user behavior, where their eyes went first, what caught their attention, and what didn't. Follow-up questions then captured both quantitative metrics and rich qualitative insights.

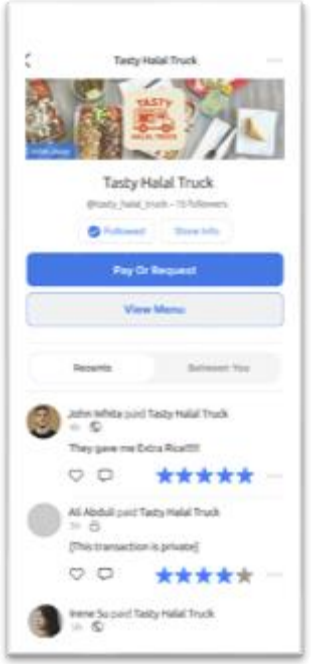
Additionally, To address confounding variables We also added prescreening questions to gauge User familiarity with Venmo, since prior knowledge could skew the results. Beyond that, we leaned into qualitative methods to pull out deeper insights—user sentiment, unmet needs, and behavior patterns we might have otherwise missed; we knew a mixed methods approach would yield broader insights.

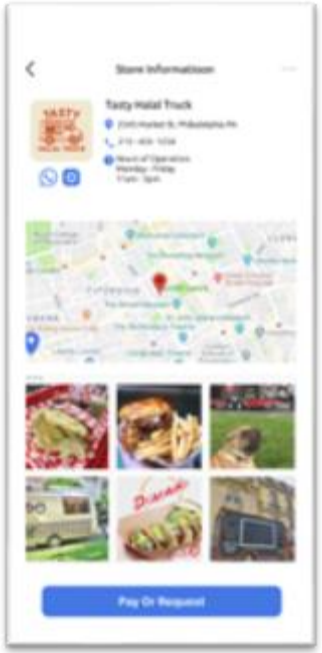
Version A

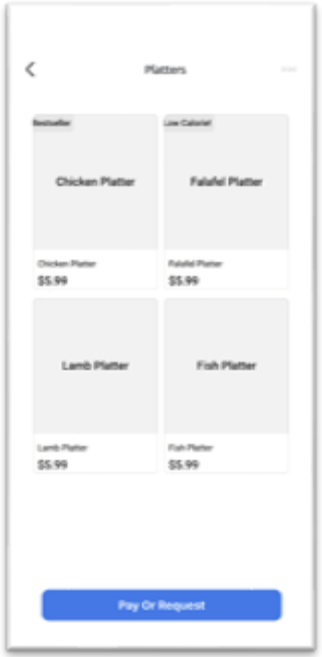

Search
Scan
Tasty Halal Truck
Pay or Request
Friend Name
Pay or Request
Completed
2025

Version B


Search
Scan
Lunch today
Remaining
Chicken over rice
Home
Cards
Pay/Request
Crypto
Me


Tasty Halal Truck
Pay Or Request
View Menu
They gave me Extra Rice!!!!
[This transaction is private]


Store Information
Tasty Halal Truck
Pay Or Request


Platters
Chicken Platter
Falafel Platter
$5.99
$5.99
Lamb Platter
Fish Platter
$5.99
$5.99
Pay Or Request

Phase 2 Results & Analysis

Method of Collection

- We conducted an interactive survey using Maze that included tasks for navigating the Venmo prototype like finding business profiles and following businesses. These tasks were designed to simulate real user flows and observe behavior in both Variant A and Variant B.
- Each design variant was embedded directly into the survey, and participants were asked to engage with separate versions. This ensured unbiased exposure and allowed for consistent comparisons between the two experiences.
- After completing the tasks, participants provided qualitative feedback on trust, navigation ease, and design preference.

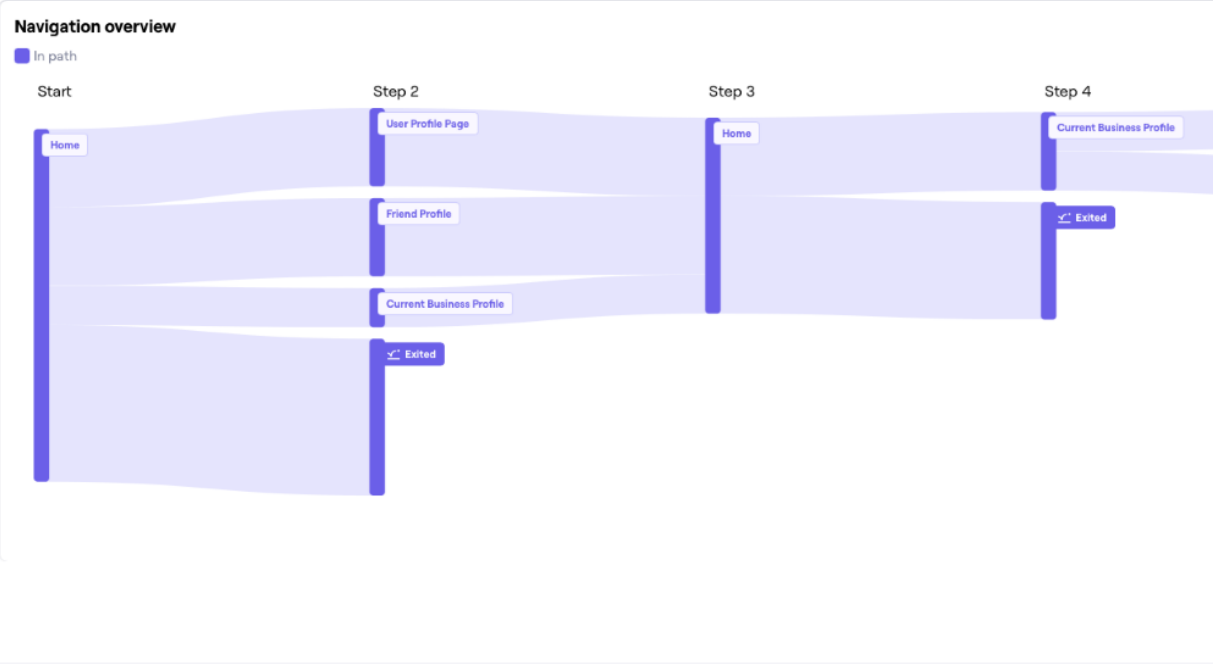
Participant Targeting:

We conducted testing primarily with two participant groups:

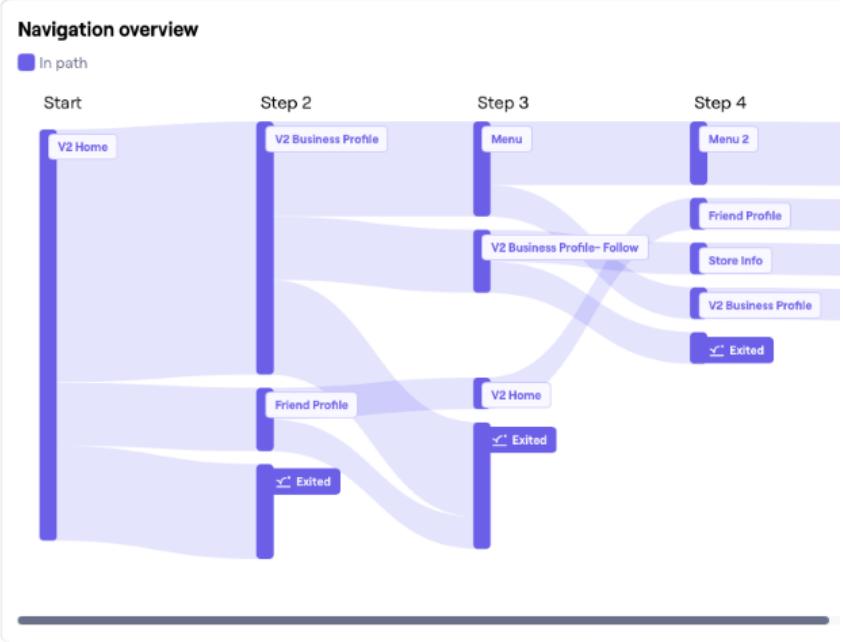
1. Classmates
2. Friends

Analysis – Discoverability & Engagement

Version A (Original Venmo)



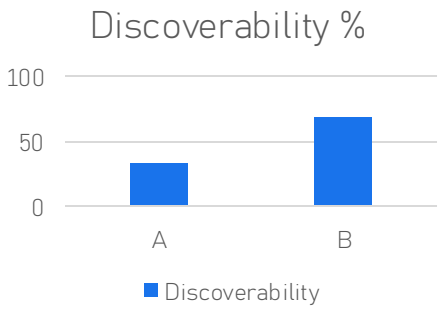
Version B (Enhanced Business Profile)

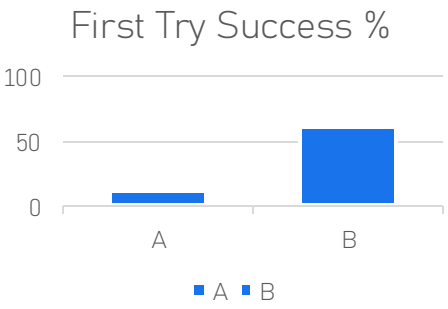


First-Try Success Rate: 11.11% in Control vs. 61.58% in Treatment – 5x improvement.

Profile Discovery Rate: 33% (Control) vs. 69% (Treatment).

Treatment users clicked and interacted more with the improved business page. They navigated to the menu page and store information page, showing interest in the business's offerings. Additionally, the Follow button, a new feature in Variant B, indicated potential for ongoing **engagement** and retention, which we were able to see in Version B.





Analysis – Metrics of Variant B Improvement

Metrics of improvement were measured on scales and asked to users after viewing the prototype. The results can be seen below:

Metric	Control (A)	Treatment (B)
Ease of Finding (1–8)	4.5	7.3
Informativeness (1–10)	3.8	6.3
Trust (1–10)	4.3	6.5

These improvements in subjective ratings mirror the behavioral patterns observed. The redesigned business profile not only improved user interaction but also shaped more positive perceptions of legitimacy and professionalism, which are key to fostering trust.

Analysis – Qualitative Feedback

Open-ended responses helped us uncover more nuanced user attitudes. In the treatment group, users consistently mentioned professional appearance, easy access to menus, and integrated store information as standout features. Many stated that these elements made the business feel more established and trustworthy.

One user praised the new experience (B):

- *"I liked the integration of photos and store information within the app. Being able to look at the menu made the whole experience feel very contained."*

Others offered suggestions (B):

- *"I would add a way to contact the business, an address, maybe a link to the website." "Maybe having a feature where you can see what trucks/businesses near you accept Venmo."*

In contrast, users described the old Venmo (A) as:

- *"It looked just like regular Venmo. I didn't even realize it was a business."*

These qualitative patterns reinforce what the data showed quantitatively: without dedicated space or branding, business profiles fail to stand out and capture user attention.

Analysis – Conclusions

What went well: ✅

- Strong discoverability improvement
- Good planning
- Useful survey responses

Areas to improve: ❤️‍🩹

- Added “brand trust” too late and didn’t measure it effectively.
- Business profile info was over-complicated and could be simplified
- Follow button data not analyzed

Our A/B test demonstrates that enhanced business profile design within Venmo improves both initial discoverability and deeper user engagement, while also increasing trust and perceived informativeness. The treatment variant not only enabled users to find and explore the business more easily but also encouraged follow-up interactions and higher sentiment. These outcomes directly support our hypothesis and provide a strong foundation for further design recommendations.

Recommendation

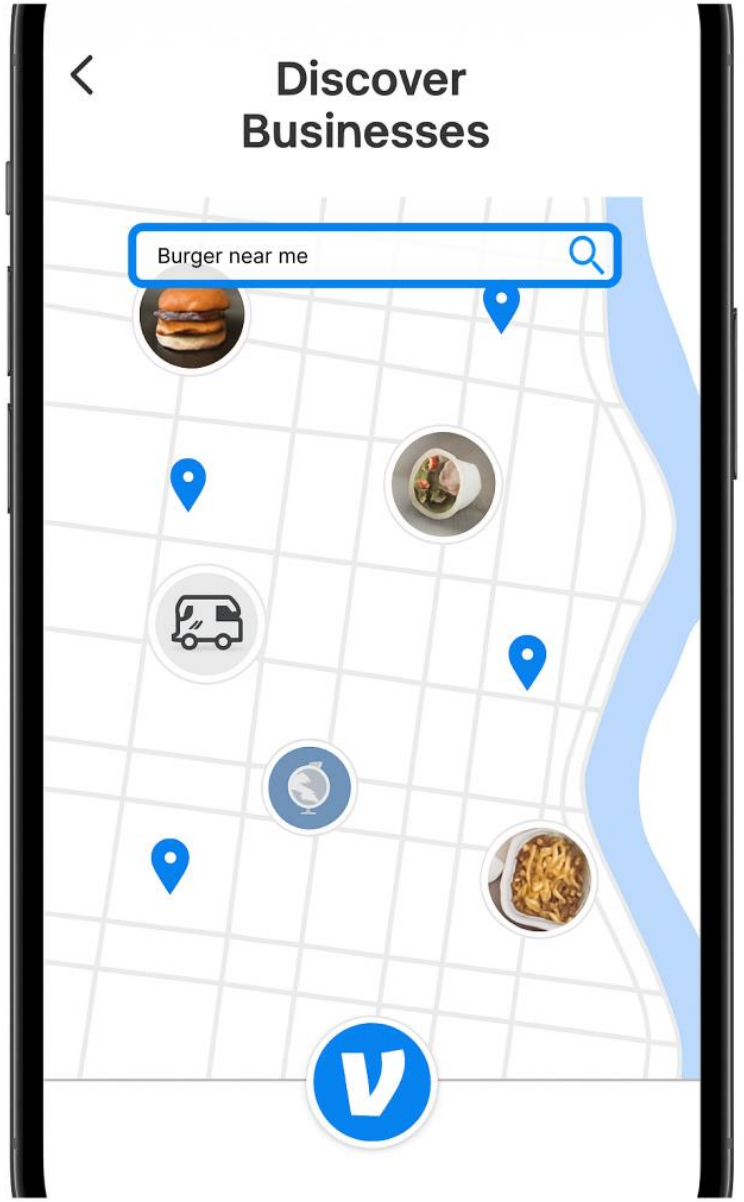
Location Based Business Search

Problem: Difficult to find/distinguish nearby businesses.

Solution:

Features:

- Find business nearby
- Filter by distance, category, review scores, etc.
- Access businesses pages right from the map

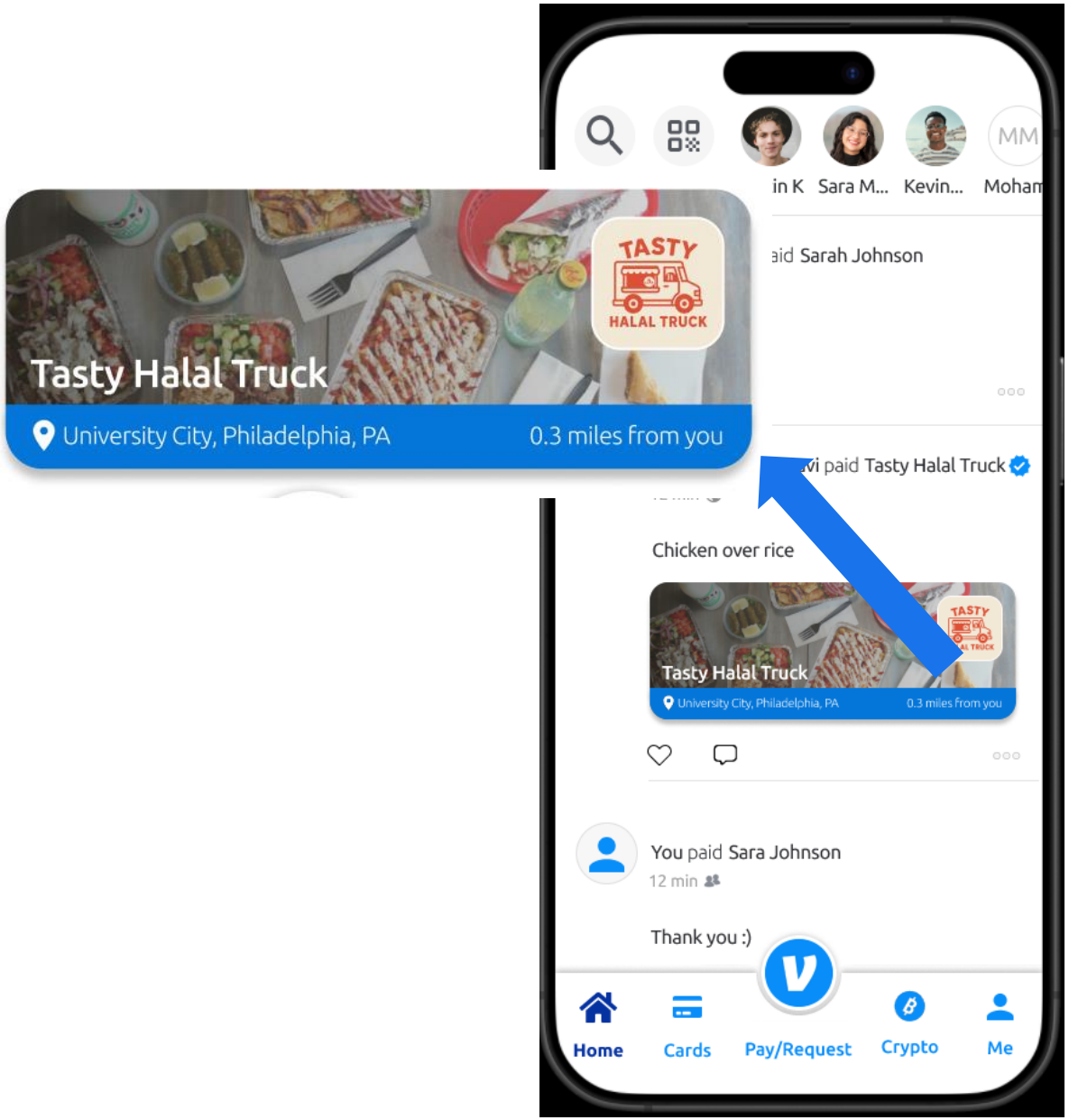


Distance-From-You On Business Card

Problem: Seeing irrelevant businesses.

Solution:

- On the homepage only show businesses reachable by the viewer
- On the business card show the distance from the viewer to reduce clicking on irrelevant businesses.

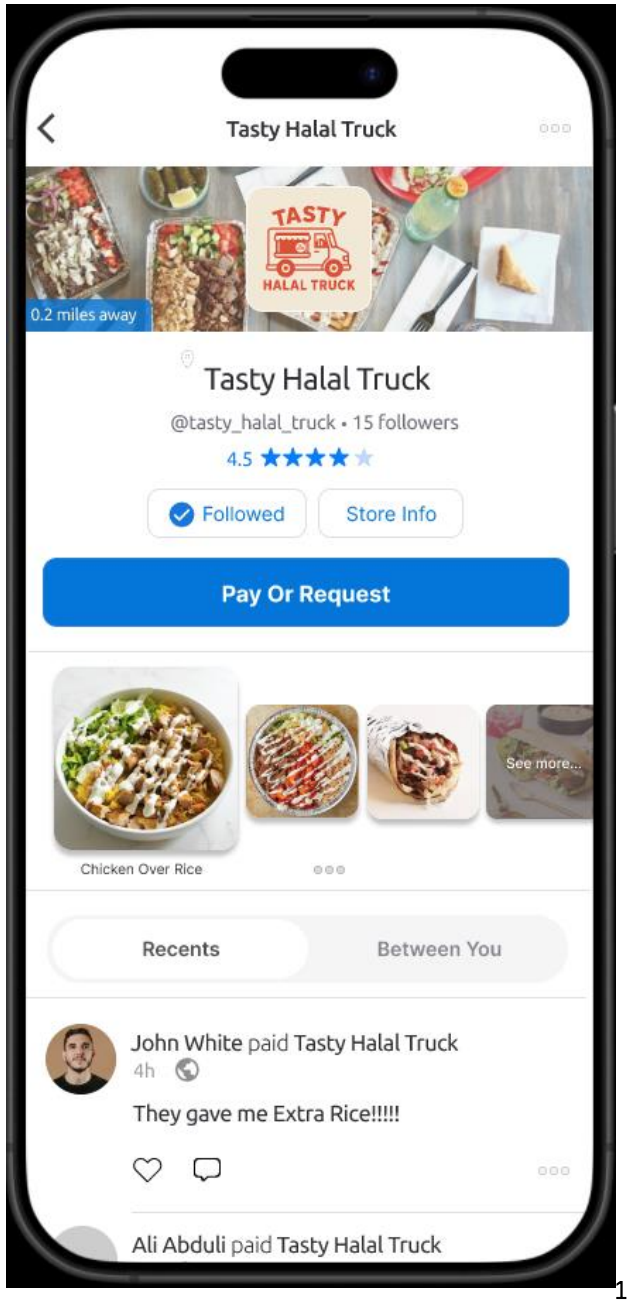


Simplified Menu

Problem: Having a detailed menu resembles food ordering apps and is confusing.

Solution:

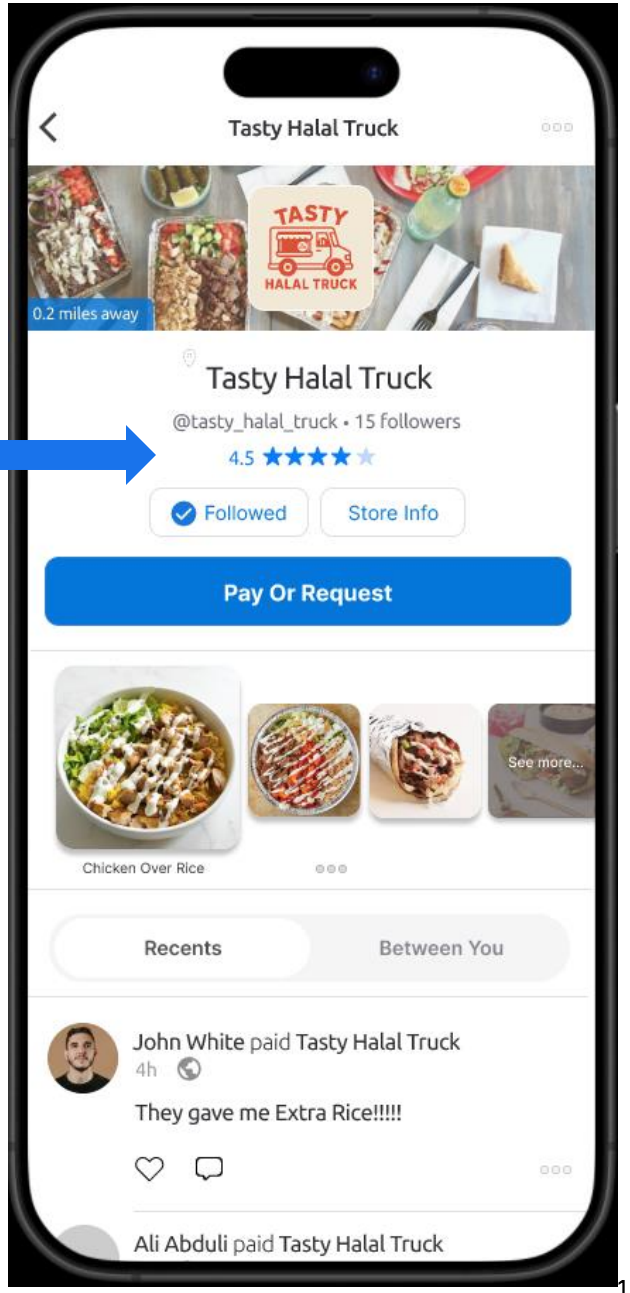
- Remove Menu page
- Show a snapshot of the main product/menu.
- Only add product/food images and add a link to Yelp or Google Maps page to more info.



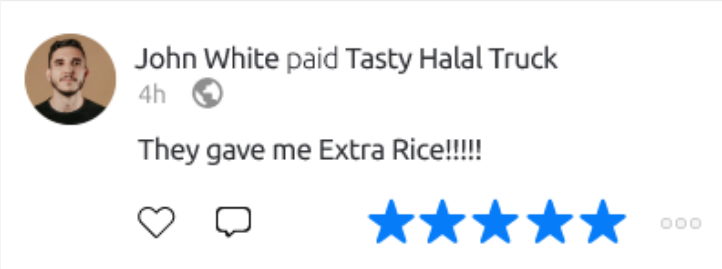
Average Review Score

Problem: Average review score was missing from the old version

Solution: Added to the top of the page.



Ethical Considerations – Design



To protect user privacy while maintaining transparency, our enhanced Venmo business profile design should offer an option for users to share their transactions and reviews anonymously. This means that while the content remains visible to the public, personal identifiers such as the user's name and profile are removed. This approach would promote honest feedback and engagement without compromising individual privacy, aligning with ethical standards and user trust expectations.